

## Hosted E-mail

This option is much better for the majority of smaller companies, as the hardware and software are all taken care of by the hosting provider. A company knows exactly how much it has to pay every month or every year when opting for this solution. The security is also taken care of by the hosting provider, as are all the licensing issues for software.

Setting up e-mail access for employees is then only a matter of configuring Outlook for POP3 access and creating user accounts via the hosting provider's Web interface. Here again, you can choose from a range of options.

For instance, you can either choose to go with an Indian e-mail hosting provider or opt for a cheaper US one. There is also a lot of legal jargon to sift through when you make your decision, and you should always remember to read the fine print in the terms and conditions.

Depending on the size of your business, and the number of employees, you can make the right choice for your e-mail solution. Now, let's look at providing a solution for companies that have between 25 and 100 employees.

## Services

Mention the term 'business e-mail solution' and everyone thinks of Rediff's and Indiatimes' business e-mail models. Undoubtedly, these are very popular, but not necessarily the best solutions for companies with more than 25 employees. Let's find out why...

Both Rediff and Indiatimes offer very similar services, as you will see in the Comparison Chart. Unfortunately, what they offer is just plain e-mail addresses—no hosting, no domain, and in fact, sometimes even the domain is not registered in your name, though you pay for it.

We compared them to GoDaddy.com's most basic offering to see whether it made any sense to opt for these popular e-mail hosts. As you can see, if your company has no more than five employees, GoDaddy works out to be a little more expensive. On the other hand, when you consider buying even a minimum of 50 e-mail addresses, the Indian solutions lose out completely.

Your GoDaddy.com email account is fast, ultra-reliable and secure. It's POP3 configured and advertising-free. It offers unique you@yourdomain.com personalization. It allows you to send and receive email using popular email clients like Microsoft Outlook, Outlook Express and more.

Whichever plan you choose, you'll enjoy these powerful essentials:

- **"Phishing" fraud protection.** Powerful technology spots email that's not from whom it claims to be before it hits your inbox.
- **Spam filtering.** This smart technology identifies spam before it can become a nuisance. And you can train it to learn and defeat new spam techniques as you go.
- **Virus protection.** Keeps your computer safe from the malicious viruses that lurk in innocent-looking emails.
- **And much more!** See the sidebar (right) for a complete listing.

Why our personalized e-mail accounts are the best alternative to Hotmail, Yahoo! Mail and similar e-mail types.

| Choose the plan that's right for you!                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1 Email Address</li> <li>25MB Total Storage</li> </ul> <p><b>Economy Plan</b><br/>Just \$9.95/yr</p> <p>FREE with your domain registration, transfer or renewal</p>                                                                                                                                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>5 Email Addresses</li> <li>100MB Total Storage</li> </ul> <p><b>Deluxe Plan</b><br/>Just \$19.95/yr</p> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>100 Email Addresses</li> <li>2000MB Total Storage</li> </ul> <p><b>Premium Plan</b><br/>Just \$29.95/yr</p> <p><b>Best Value!</b></p> |
| <p>Facilitate your Email Account with <b>Fax Thru Email</b>, the fast, easy way to send and receive faxes anywhere, anytime, from any computer. <b>Starting at Just \$9.95/mo!</b></p> <p><input type="checkbox"/> Add Fax Thru Email! Toll-Free# Deluxe (200min) \$19.95/mo</p>                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <p>On-the-go access to any file! <b>Online File Folder</b> gives you instant access to all your important files from any computer connected to the Internet. Perfect in the office, at home or on the road. <b>As low as \$4.95/yr!</b></p> <p><input type="checkbox"/> Add Online File Folder to my Email Account! Economy Edition - \$4.95/yr</p> |                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <p>NEW! Keep your group or office organized with <b>Online Group Calendar</b>. Schedule events and meetings, manage tasks and resources, upload and share files. <b>Now as low as \$8.95!</b></p> <p><input type="checkbox"/> Add Online Group Calendar to my Email Account! Up to 3 users - \$8.95</p>                                             |                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                              |

GoDaddy's e-mail solutions are much cheaper for those with more than 50 employees

If you opt for GoDaddy's services, remember that with the Premium e-mail option there is no domain name included, so that will be an additional cost.

The ideal solution seems to be to buy the domain name from GoDaddy.com, and then buy the Web site hosting as well. When you buy even the most basic Web site hosting package from Godaddy.com (\$3.95 a month or about Rs 2,000 a year), you are given 100 e-mail IDs with 500 MB space absolutely free.

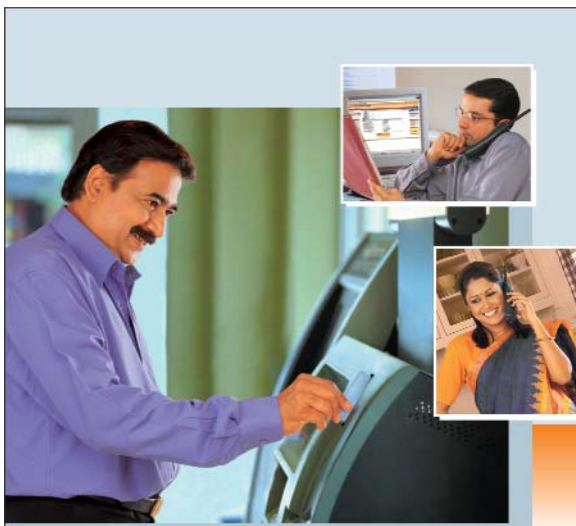
Essentially, if you are buying a new domain, all you need to do is buy hosting and the business e-mail is provided at no extra cost. The only difference is the smaller mailbox size of 5 MB per user! You still get all the features of the premium plans as well, such as spam filters, virus checks, POP3 access and even Web mail...

## In Summation

As you have now seen in this article, getting personalised e-mail addresses can hardly be considered expensive anymore; and it doesn't require a Linux guru to set up. The Web interface means that anybody with just basic Internet experience can start setting up e-mail accounts for your employees.

The fact that the solutions mentioned here cost next to nothing should make you consider opting for an outsourced e-mail solution for your business. Remember, you can't make any more excuses now; it's time to do away with that amateurish appearance by giving your business the professional look it deserves! ☐

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Makes us Good people to bank with.

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- Transact through any of our countrywide networked ATMs and CashTree ATMs
- Get your balance, statement of account as well as transfer funds through ATMs, Internet Banking or Telebanking
- Reserve your train tickets / pay your bills / Taxes through Internet Banking
- Multi-city cheques operating in over 150 centres
- Instant Inter-bank Fund Transfer (RTGS) facility through all CBS branches

www.unionbankofindia.com

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